

Soar

Helping students find education
& work abroad



Roles

- UX Researcher
- UI Designer

Time Frame

- 3 months

Tools

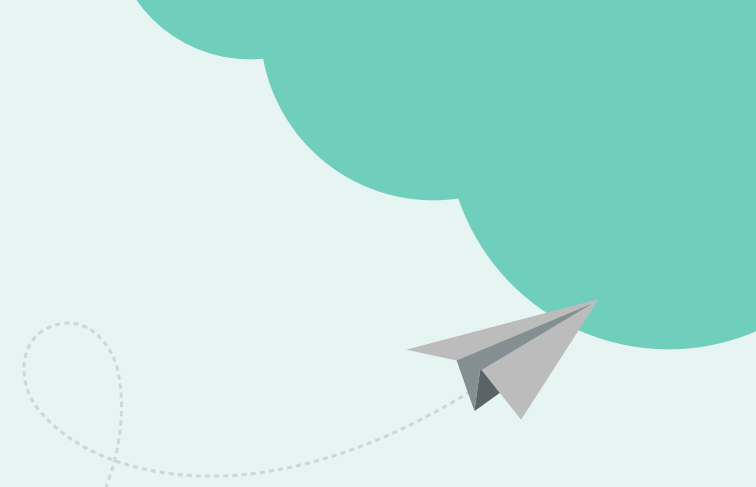
- Figma
- Adobe Illustrator

Problem Statement

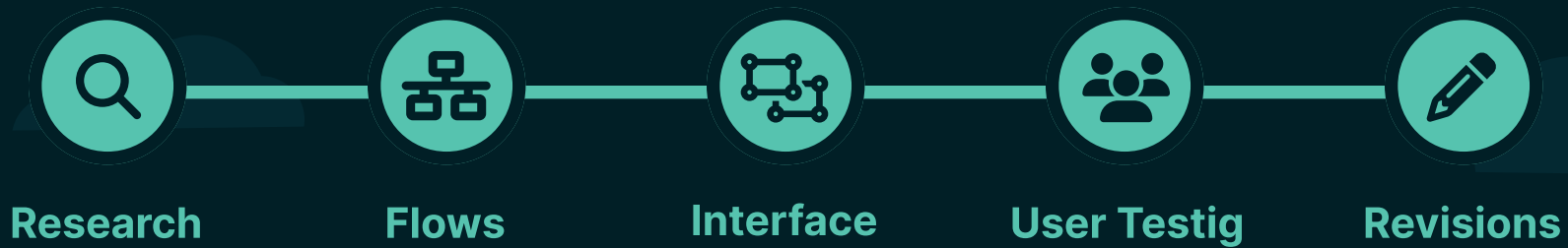
Having discussed the topic of studying abroad with fellow students, they all shared their frustrations and anxiety with the process. **My goal is to make the planning and preparation process of traveling abroad simpler, easier, and more reassuring.**

Solutions

Through our app, students can access travel documents, **book meetings** with counselors, **explore program options** and work opportunities, **apply for traveling scholarships**, and more.



Design Process



User Research

Utilized a three-step approach to guide app development. First, user persona to define the ideal customer profile. Next, SWOT analysis to identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats. Finally, competitive analysis to understand the existing market.

| User Persona



Alexa Thomas

Age: **23**

Major: **Business**

Academic Level: **4th year**

Status: **Full-time student**

Skills

- Great communicator
- Leadership skills
- Ability to adapt

Creative

Hard Working

Adaptable

Goals

- To travel
- Gain life experience
- Get a full-time job

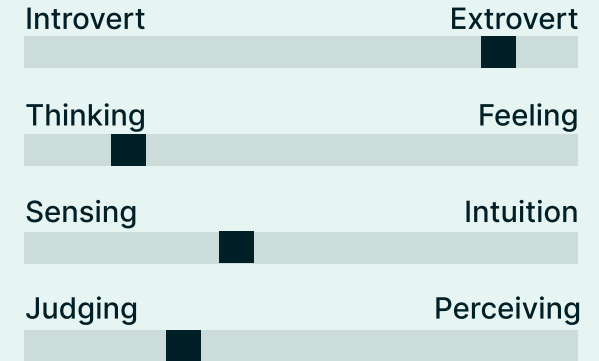
Frustrations

- Finding jobs abroad
- Finding programs for her major
- Finding resources

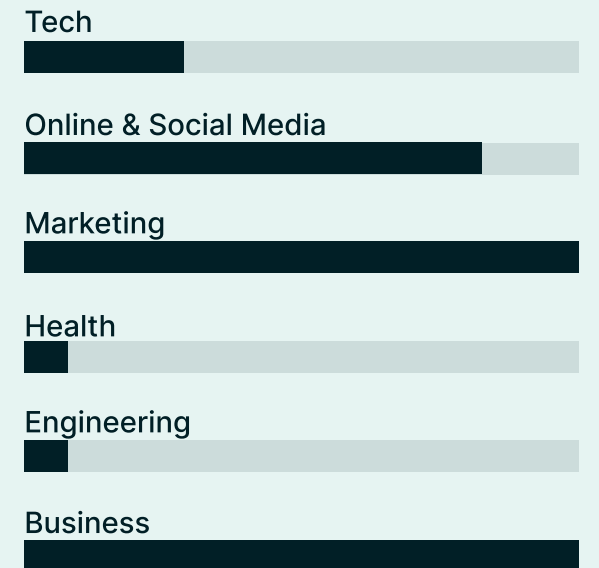
Bio

Alex is a 4th year student majoring in Business. She has been living in Oklahoma for a few years now and would like to travel after she graduates. She has experience interning for few companies in her local city, but she is now ready for change. She loves meeting new people and learning about different cultures. One of her goals is to travel the world. She has looked into internships abroad that the program at her school provides but they didn't have options for her major. She has also looked for programs outside her school, but they were difficult to find.

Personality



Areas of Interest



Strengths



- Easier experience for the student.
- Offer all the resources students will need all in one app/platform.

Weakness



- Too many features (checklist, currency converter, counseling, etc.)
- up-keeping (ensuring documents and info is up to date)

Opportunities



- Build partnerships with businesses around the world
- Can be promoted on schools

Threats



- Traveling/Visa changes or complications
- Competitors has a lot of well organized packaged programs

| Comparative Analysis

WWOOF

- ✓ **Strengths:**
 - many locations
- ✗ **Weakness:**
 - focuses on farms and agriculture

CIEE

- ✓ **Strengths:**
 - Personal meetings with counselor
- ✗ **Weakness:**
 - Limited programs
 - Limited locations
 - Limited majors
 - Expensive

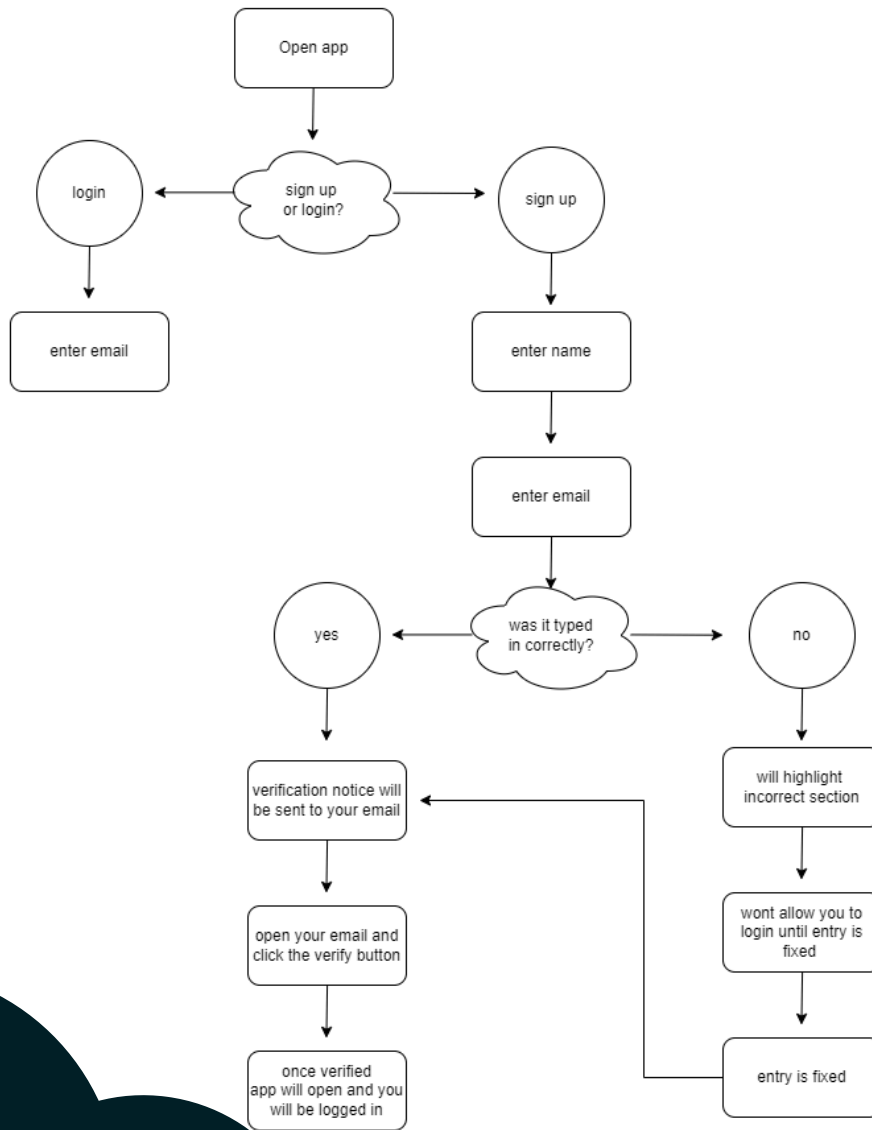
School Programs

- ✓ **Strengths:**
 - well known
 - organized
 - offers study and jobs
 - easy application
- ✗ **Weakness:**
 - application fee
 - expensive
 - focuses on study
 - advising is offered after applying
 - have to use website

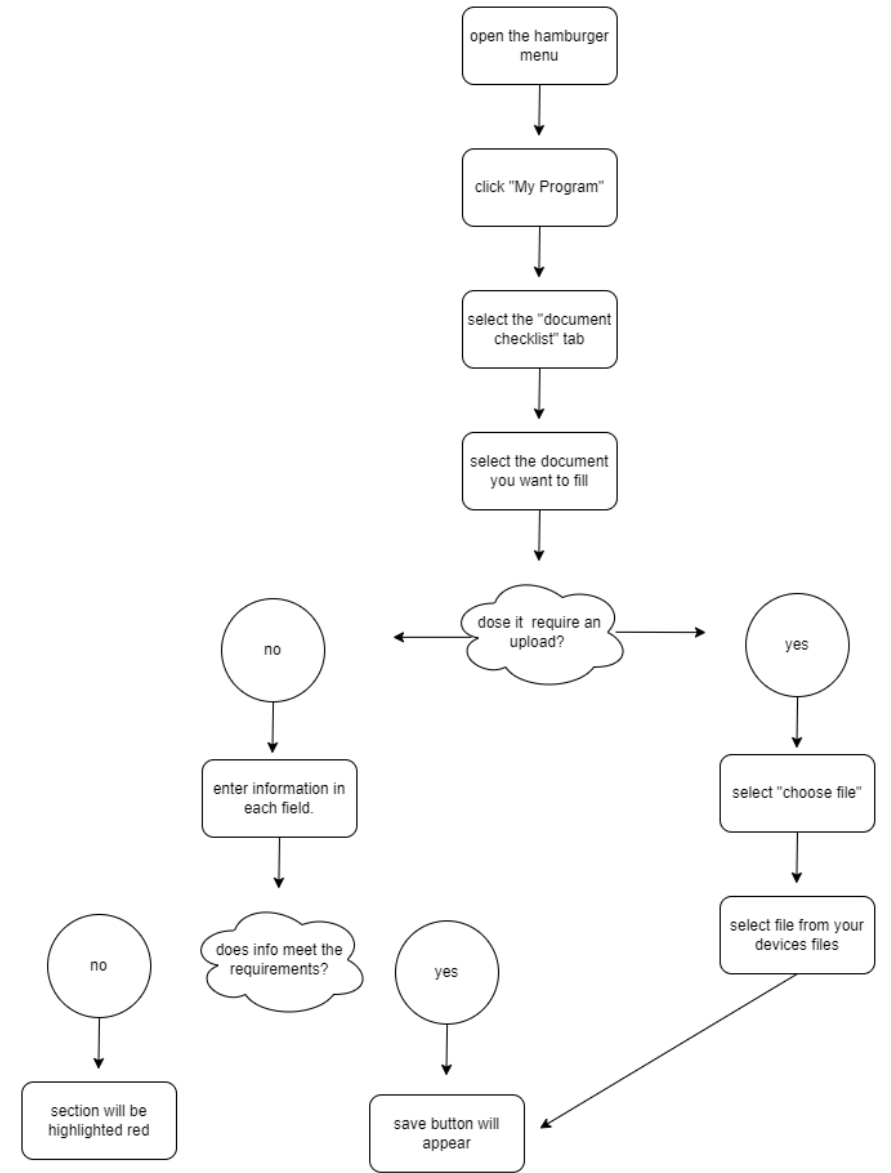
What Soar offers:

- Include both study and work abroad opportunities
- Many location options
- Programs that matches their needs
- Can talk to counselors and advisors prior to deciding on a program.

User Flow

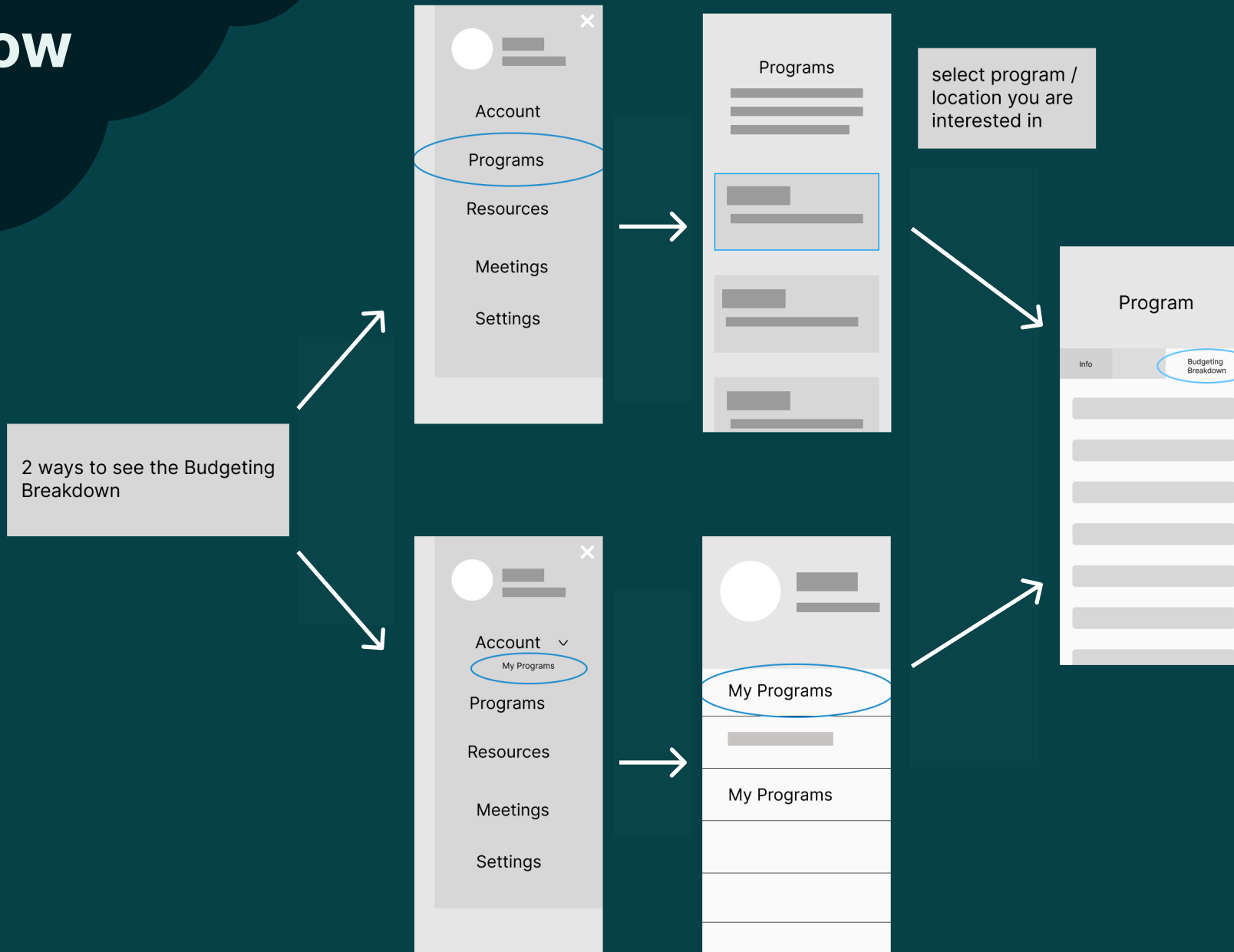


Task #1 - Login



Task #2 - Document Form

| Wire Flow



My research identified **3 core functions** for the app:

- **Document checklist** - for travel requirements.
- **Virtual Advising Appointments** - Students could schedule meetings with advisors prior to committing to a specific programs.
- **Filtering the programs** - Can apply filters to help them narrow down their options.

This helped me determine which features to include and what solutions I should prioritize moving forward

User Interface

To make navigating the overseas process less daunting, I designed the app to be both professional and cheerful. Using vibrant colors and lively graphics, I created an environment that excites users rather than making them anxious. The goal was to create a reassuring experience that encourages users to explore with confidence.

| Visual Design

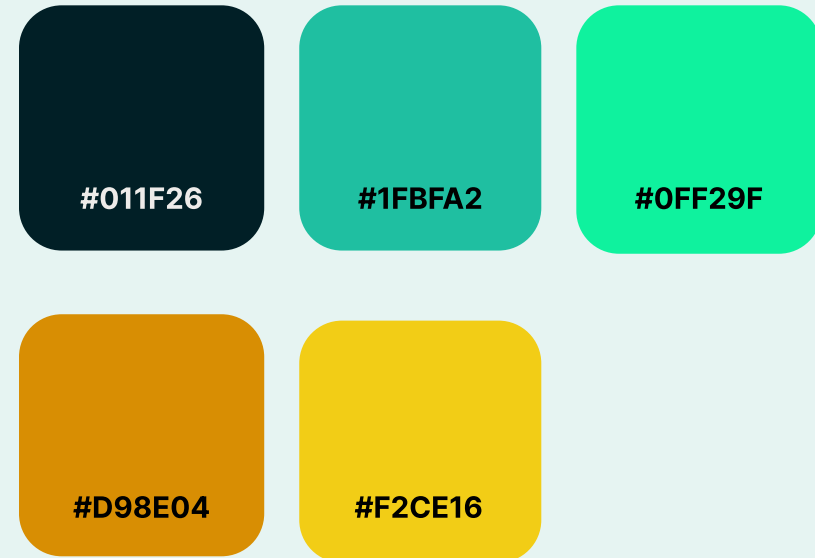
Typefaces

Familjen Grotesk

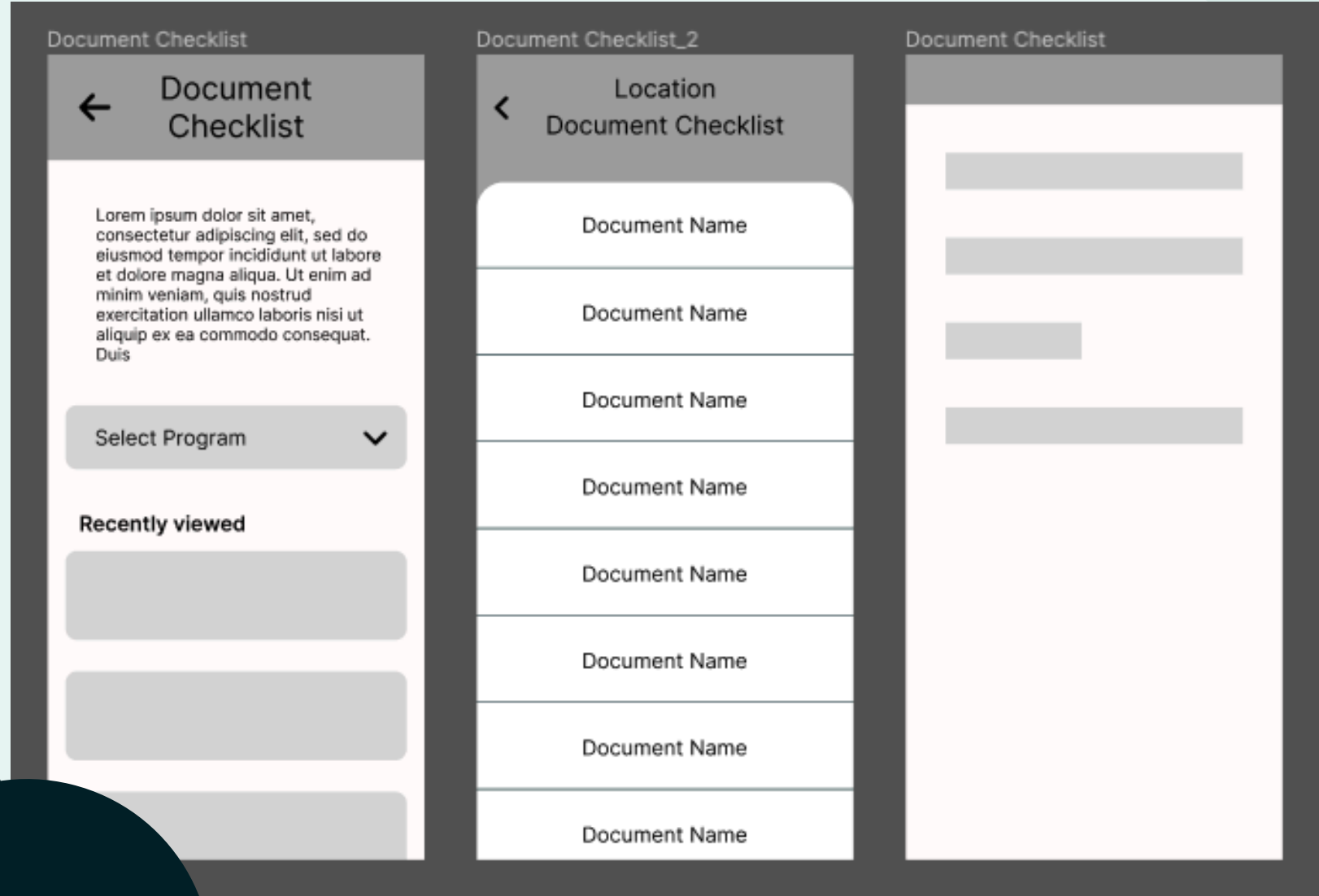
Designed by [Familjen STHLM AB](#)

- Creates a professional yet playful feel.
- A user mentioned that it reminded them of airport signage (which plays into the travel theme).

Color Pallet

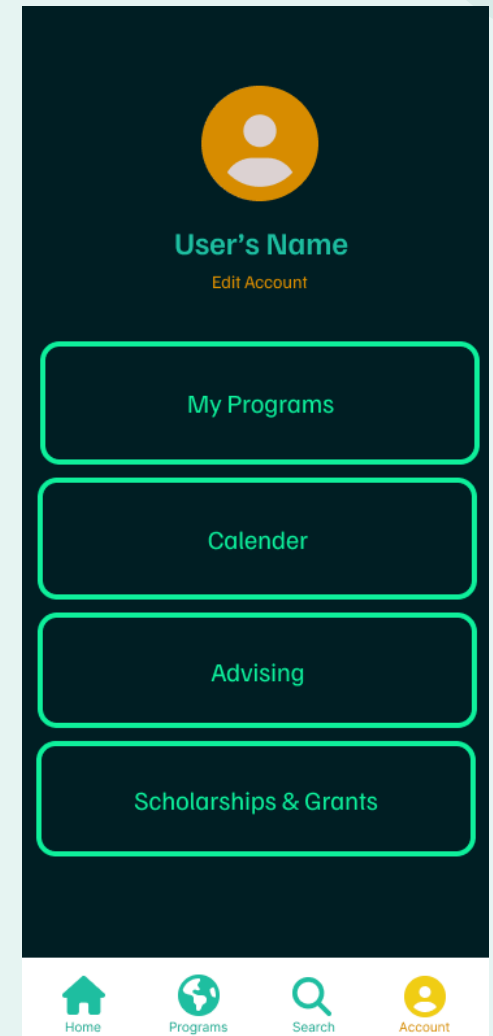
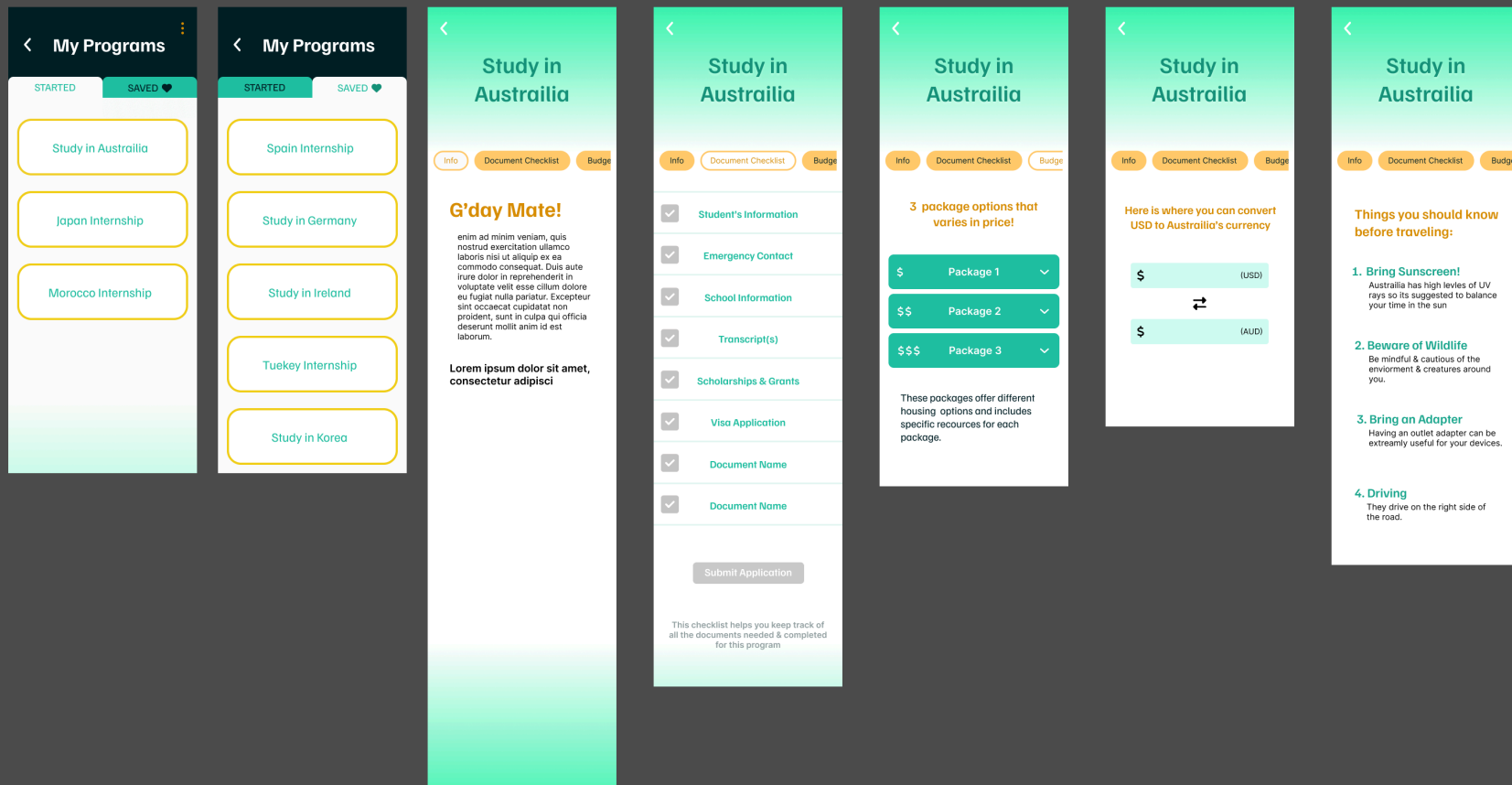


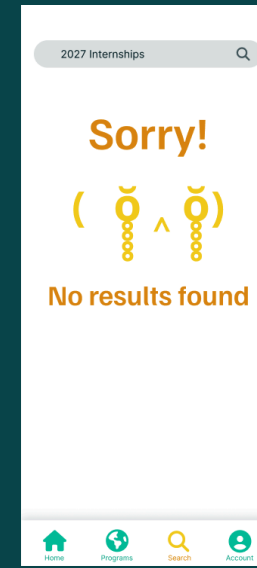
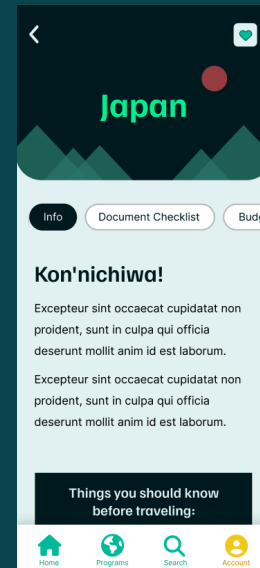
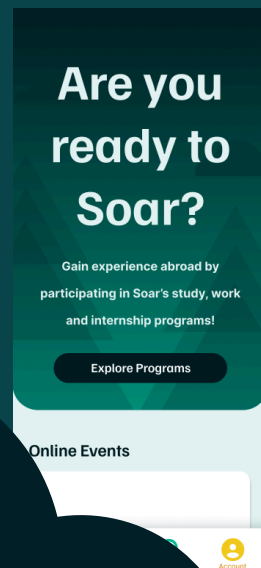
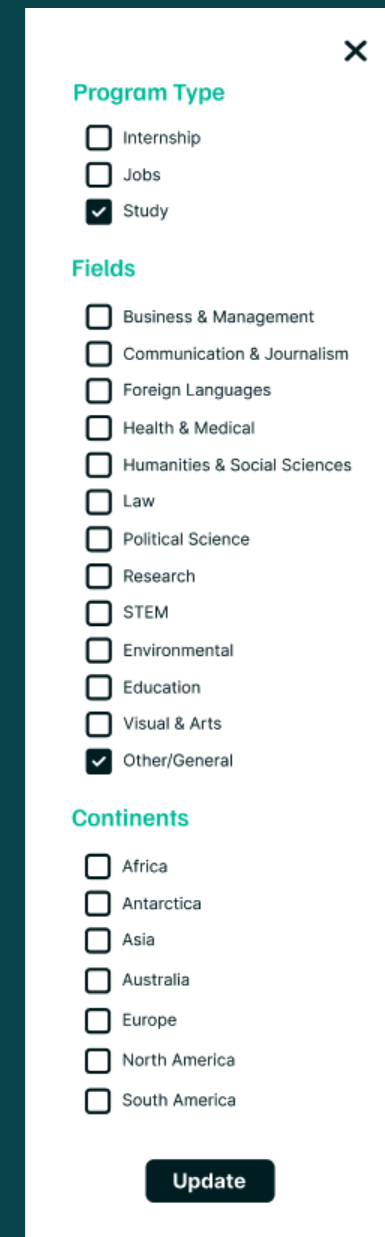
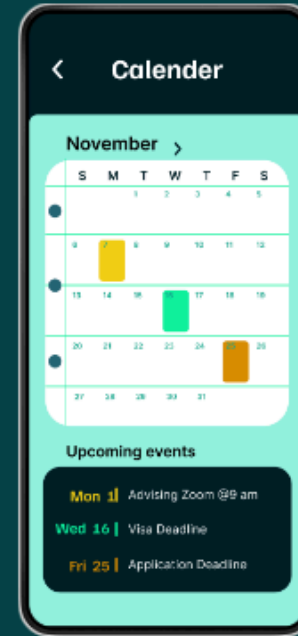
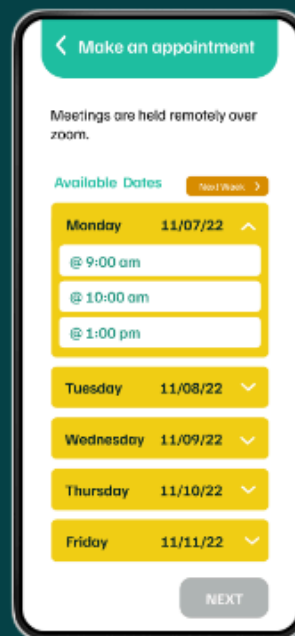
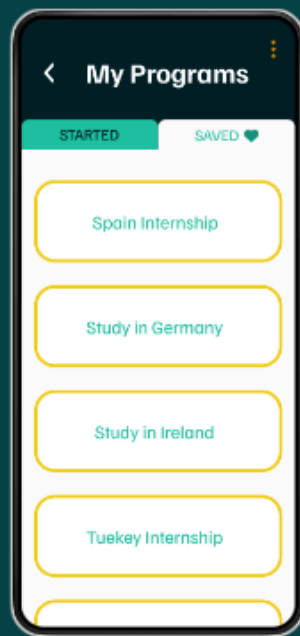
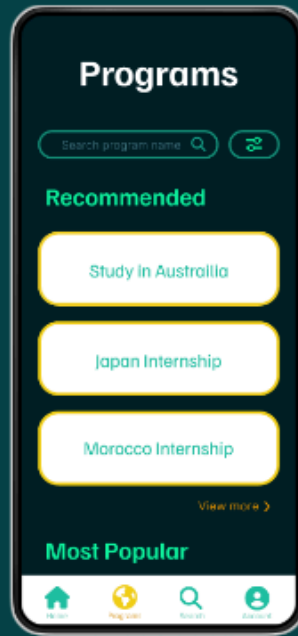
- Blues and greens resembles land and sea
- Yellows resembles architecture and the sun.



| Low-Fidelity

Mid-Fidelity





| High-Fidelity

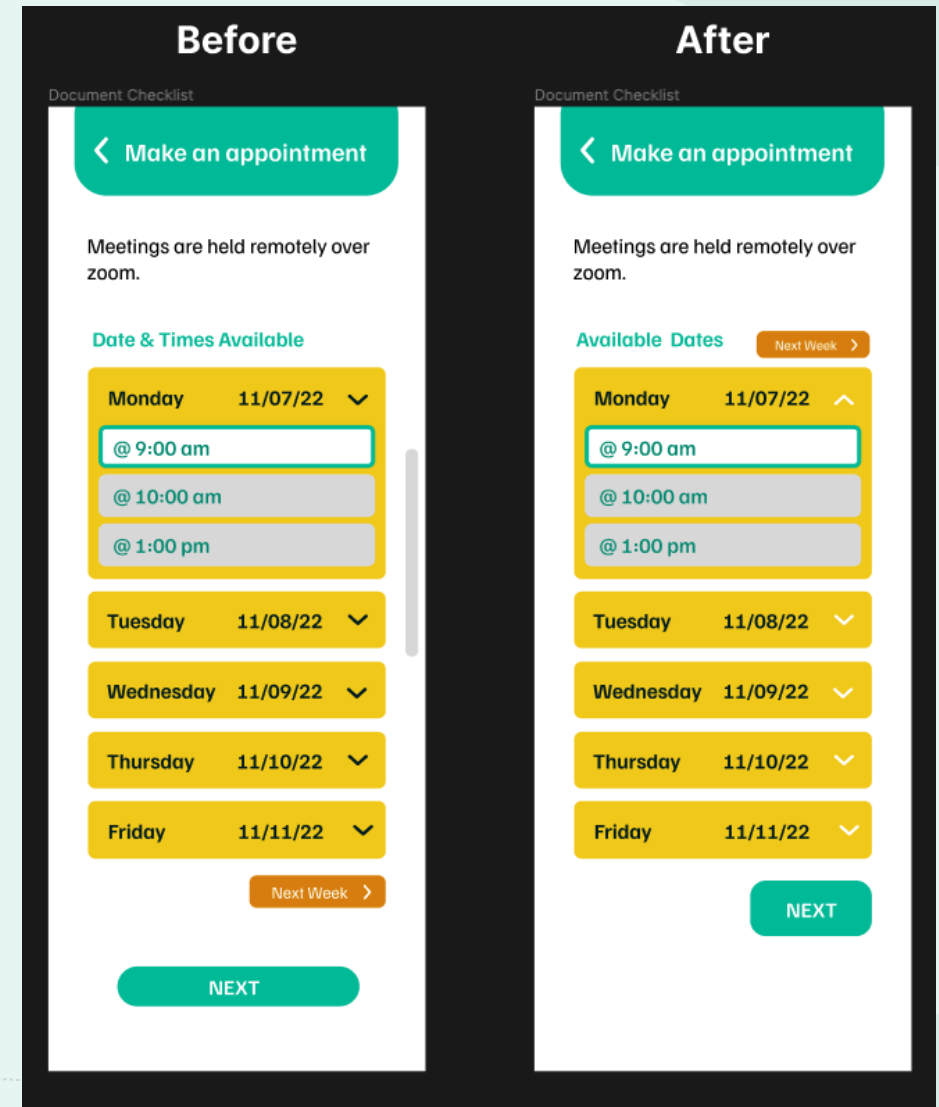
User Testing & Revisions

| User Testing

I ran **two rounds** of user testing for this app. The first was **during the mid fi stage**, and the second was **during the high fi stage**. Each round involved 3-4 college students, who were given test scenarios to explore the app s different features.

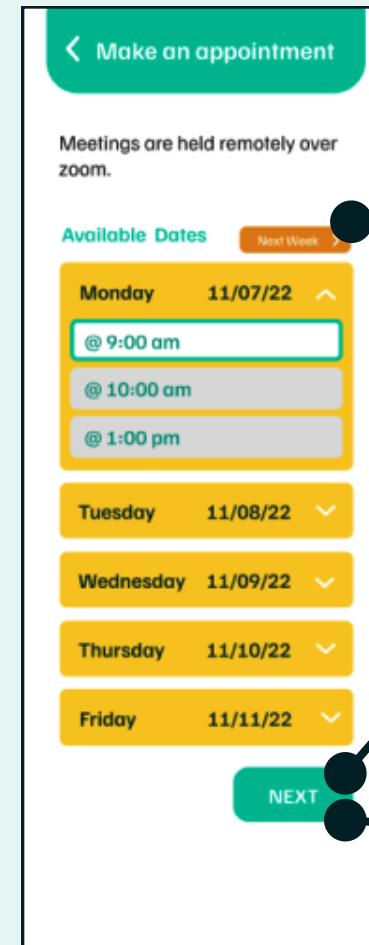
Key Issues

- Button Arrangement
- Click Ability
- 'Sent messages' task navigation



Considering that button arrangements, click-ability, and navigation confusion were observed during the user testing, I opted to implement some changes:

Added a kebab menu
(to indicate that there are additional options)

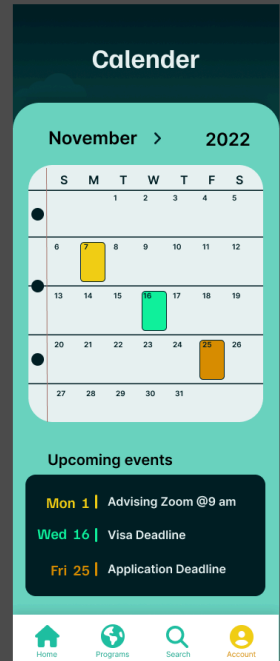
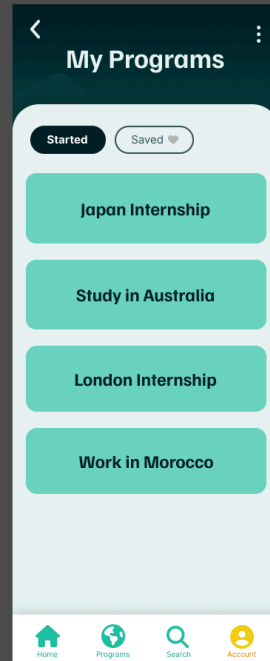
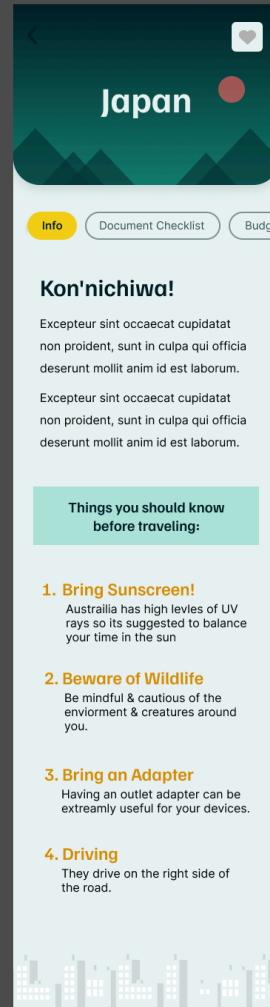
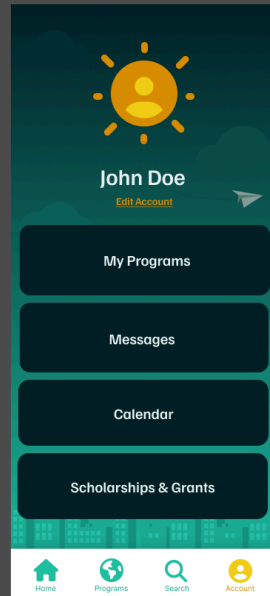
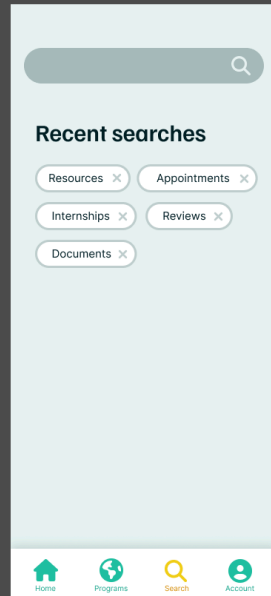
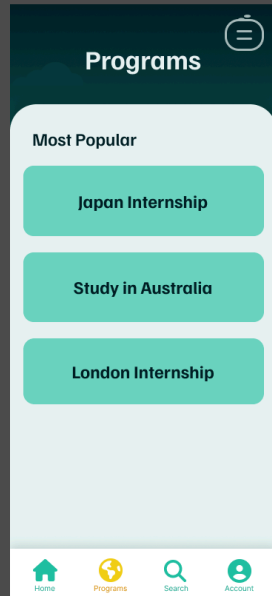
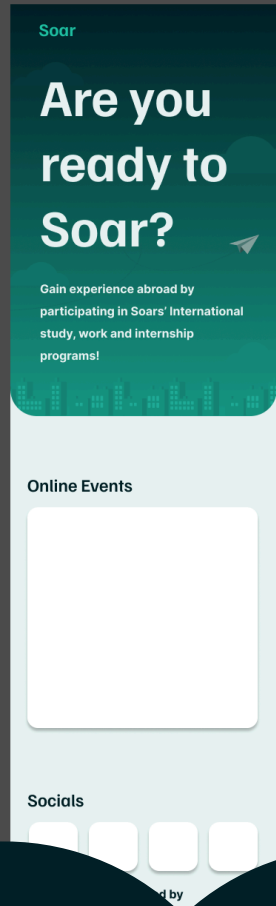


Moved 'Next Week' button to top (for easy access)

Changed the shape of the 'NEXT' button (to keep consistency)

Rearranged the layout (so users can find the 'NEXT' button)

| Revisions



| New High - Fidelity

| Summary

During a three-week project, I honed my design abilities by mastering flows, refining critical thinking, and emphasizing usability and content organization in app design. This experience significantly shaped my perspective as a designer, challenging assumptions and highlighting the paramount importance of usability.

Moving forward, I m committed to prioritizing usability and content organization in all my design endeavors, integrating the lessons learned from this project. I plan to continue refining UI design and leveraging graphics to elevate user perception, confident that with more time, I can further enhance the user experience through these refinements.

